

Stanley Okwii

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Summary

Senior engineer with 6+ years shipping production systems in Python and TypeScript on AWS, spanning payment platforms, analytics products, and data pipelines. Currently building an LLM research assistant end-to-end as a founding engineer: retrieval, evaluation, and multi-tenant infrastructure. AI-assisted development is part of my normal workflow, from coding to review and testing.

Skills

Programming: Python, TypeScript, JavaScript, SQL, Dart

AI/ML: RAG pipelines, LLM integration (Claude and Gemini APIs), LLM evaluation, prompt engineering, agent and tool-use workflows, vector search (pgvector), embeddings, hybrid retrieval

Backend and Frameworks: Django, FastAPI, Flask, Node.js, Express, GraphQL, Celery, Redis

Frontend and Mobile: React, Next.js, Flutter

Databases: PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redis, MySQL

Infrastructure: AWS (ECS, Bedrock, CloudFormation), GCP, Docker, GitHub Actions CI/CD, Supabase, Sentry, New Relic, Terraform / Kubernetes

Developer Tooling: Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Git, GitHub Actions, Antigravity CLI

Experience

Founding Engineer, Access to Energy – London, UK Jan 2026 – present

AI research assistant for energy access in Africa: evidence-based answers with citations from a curated library of sector reports. Team of 4; I own the backend, AI pipeline, and infrastructure.

- Built the end-to-end RAG pipeline and its evaluation harness, benchmarking hybrid retrieval on pgvector against a keyword-only baseline across a labelled question set
- Designed the agent workflow that routes questions, calls retrieval and citation tools, and refuses when the knowledge library lacks evidence — keeping every answer traceable to a source document.
- Built the document ingestion pipeline (parsing, chunking, embedding) that processes hundreds of PDFs concurrently; newly uploaded reports become searchable in minutes rather than hours.
- Designed multi-tenant data isolation with per-organisation access control and usage metering, so several research organisations share one deployment without any visibility into each other's data.
- Wrote the AWS infrastructure as CloudFormation and automated environment setup, cutting the time to stand up a new environment from days to minutes.

Senior Full-Stack Software Engineer, Harver – New York, USA (remote) Mar 2023 – May 2025

Left in May 2025 to complete my MSc full-time.

- Owned architecture and delivery of three client-facing products end-to-end (Python backend, React frontend), including the calls on security, performance, and long-term maintainability.
- Ran project planning across engineering, product, and design: scoping, trade-offs, and delivery dates that held.
- Wrote the technical documentation new engineers onboard with, covering core system workflows.
- Led 15+ technical interviews on system design and code quality, helping set the engineering hiring bar.

Full-Stack Software Engineer, Harver – New York, USA (remote)

Sept 2019 – Mar 2023

- Added structured logging and monitoring (Sentry, New Relic) across the application, cutting typical time-to-diagnose for production issues by replacing guesswork with a direct trail from error to root cause.
- Built analytics dashboards clients used to track talent growth and mobility across their organisations.
- Cut API response latency by profiling hot paths, removing N+1 queries, and adding targeted caching.
- Automated releases with CI/CD pipelines, taking frontend deployments from a manual process to one-click.

Projects

Hoppers (Event Ticketing Platform) – Remote

Oct 2025 – present

Full-Stack Software Engineer (Contract)

- Built the payment system across multiple providers, with commission tracking and booking-fee snapshots for revenue reconciliation.
- Implemented QR-code ticketing with server-side validation, per-user purchase limits, and concurrency safeguards against double-booking under load.
- Shipped team management — invitations, permissions, organiser dashboards — as primary contributor across backend, admin, and mobile.

CareerFoundry (Online Coding Bootcamp) – Berlin, Germany

Mar 2023 – Jan 2026

Full-Stack Web Development Mentor (Freelance)

- Mentored 23+ students through the Full-Stack Web Development program, holding a 5/5 rating for feedback quality and responsiveness.

Utidash — New Tab (Chrome Extension) – Berlin, Germany

Sept 2020 – Nov 2020

Full-Stack Software Engineer (Contract)

- Shipped features for a productivity extension with 6,000+ users; daily active usage rose in the following months.

Education

MSc Birkbeck, University of London, Data Analytics – London, UK

Oct 2024 – Sept 2025

- Merit. Dissertation on adversarial robustness: implemented PGD attacks from scratch and adversarially retrained ResNet-50 on ImageNet.

BSc Makerere University, Software Engineering – Kampala, Uganda

Aug 2014 – Sept 2018

- 2:1 (Upper Second Class Honours)